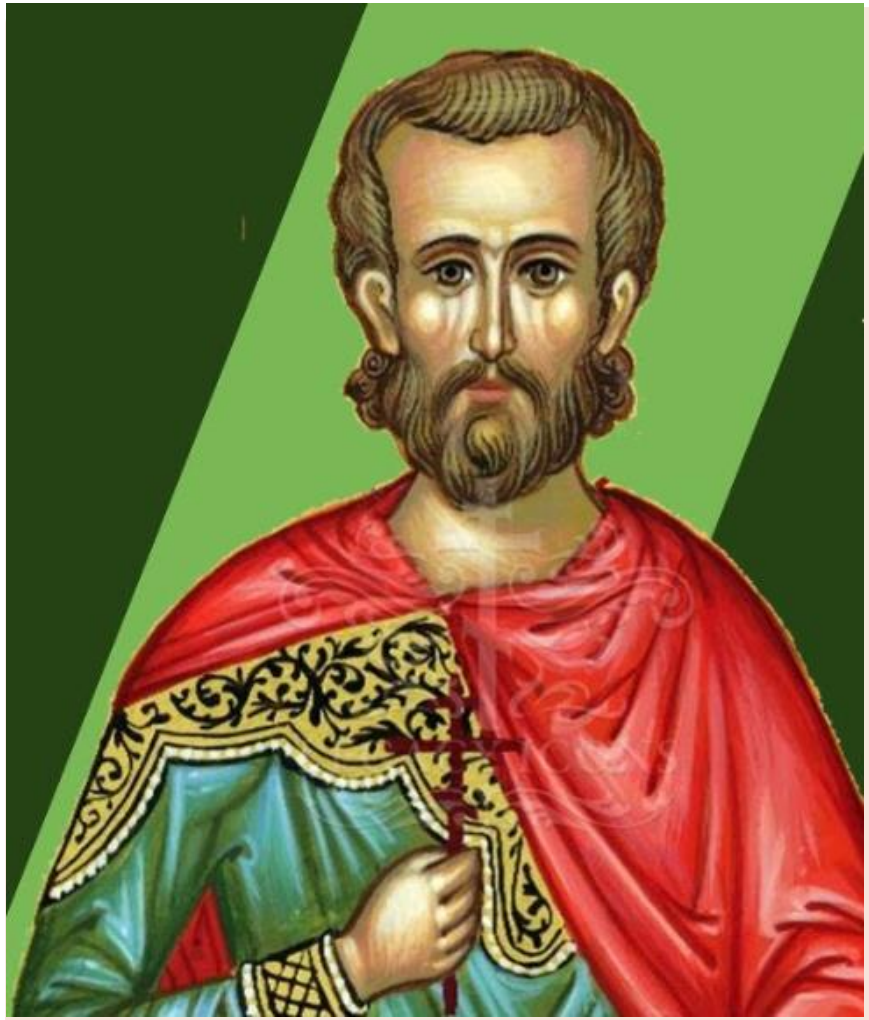


“He ascended on high; he led captivity captive; he gave gifts to the sons of men.”

Justin Martyr (165 AD)

Etymology of Spirit

Triune makes Christianity unique against the other monotheistic religions like Judaism, Islam etc.

Trinitarian monotheism serves as core and unchangeable foundation of Christianity.

It is the highest and most appropriate form of human understanding regarding the being and nature of God almighty.

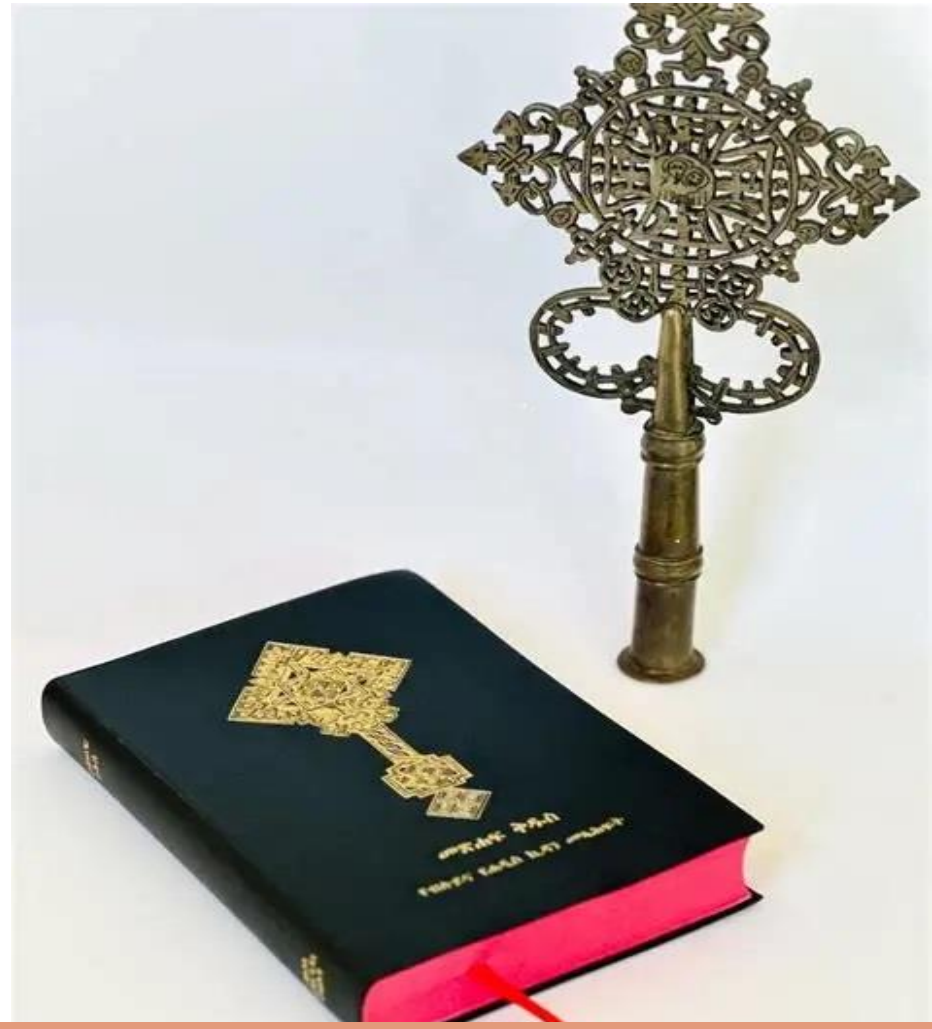
The Trinitarian nature of God has been disclosed completely in the peak and culmination of divine revelation, which is the incarnation of the second person of the Holy Trinity.



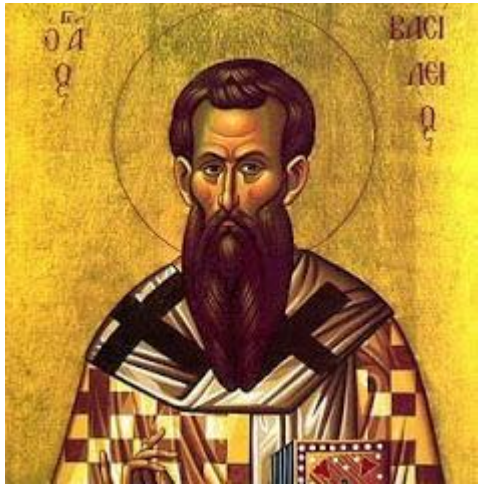
Etymology of Spirit

In the Ortodoxy, the term **"Spirit" (መንፈስ - Menfes)** is multifaceted. It is not a single definition but a concept that shifts depending on whether the subject is God, angels, or humans……

- The Holy Spirit as a Divine Person:
- Angels as Spirits:
- Human Spirit:
- The wind also called Spirit.
- Religion is also referred to as Spirit.
- Teaching is also referred to as Spirit.
- Knowledge is also referred to as Spirit.
- Will is also referred to as Spirit.
- Satan is also referred to as Spirit.



The Divine Nature (God as Spirit)



On the ground that “God is a Spirit”. In what form Of God ? Of course he ***means in some form, not in none***. For who will deny that God is a body although “ God is a Spirit?”. As being more proximate in character to God. Tertullian of Carthage (220AD)

✓Orthodox theology teaches that God is not composed of matter, body, or parts. He is a "Simple Being" who is everywhere and fills all things.

✓Spirit, which denotes His invisibility, omnipresence, and immateriality.

✓Immateriality: In all contexts, "Spirit" denotes a reality that is ረቂቅ (Reqiq) subtle, refined, and beyond the grasp of the five physical senses.

✓God's essence is spiritual, meaning He is invisible, eternal, and non-physical.

✓St. Athanasius and St. Cyril, emphasizes that God is a **“Simple Spirit”(**a Spiritual Throne/Being) who cannot be contained by space) without composition

✓ "Simple Being" who is everywhere and fills all things.

✓The EOTC strongly emphasizes that the Holy Spirit is equal in divinity to the Father and the Son, rejecting any notion that the Spirit is merely a "force.

✓The human spirit is what distinguishes humans from animals, allowing for ሃይማኖት (Faith) and communication with the Creator.

- ✓ The Holy Spirit, alongside the Father and the Son, is a distinct person of the Holy Trinity, fully equal in divinity and glory.
- ✓ The Lord Jesus Christ explicitly refers to the Spirit's divine nature when He breathes on His disciples, saying, "Receive the Holy Spirit" (John 20:22).
- ✓ Additionally, in John 4:24, the essence of God is described as Spirit, affirming His divine immateriality and omnipresence.

እስመ እግዚአብሔር መንፈስ ውእቱ፡ ወእለሂ ይሰግዱ ሎቱ በመንፈስ ወበጽድቅ ሀለዎሙ ይሰግዱ ሎቱ።" እግዚአብሔር መንፈስ ነው÷ የሚሰግዱለትም በመንፈስና በእውነት ሊሰግዱለት ያስፈልጋቸዋል።"(ዮሐንስ 4:24)



The Holy Spirit (The Third Person of the Trinity)

- ✓ The "Spirit" specifically refers to the Holy Spirit (መንፈስ ቅዱስ-Menfes Qidus), who is one of the three distinct Persons (Akalat) of the Holy Trinity
- ✓ **Procession:** The Orthodox Church teaches that the Holy Spirit proceeds from the Father alone (Original Nicene Creed). **John 15:26** — *"...the Spirit of truth who proceeds from the Father.“*
- ✓ He is the "Giver of Life"(**Mahiyawi**).
- ✓ In the **Nicene-Constantinopolitan Creed** (recited in every Liturgy), it says: *"We believe in the Holy Spirit, the Lord, the Giver of Life, who proceeds from the Father."*



Created Spirits (Angels)

Angels are called "spirits" because non-corporeal nature or they lack physical bodies (though they can ***take form*** by God's will).

Holy Angels: They are "ministering spirits."
Hebrews 1:14 *"Are they not all ministering spirits sent forth to minister for those who will inherit salvation?"*
አኮኑ ኵሎሙ መላእክት መንፈስ እሙንቱ ወይትፌነዉ ለመልእክት በእንተ እለ ሀለዎሙ ይረሱ ሕይወተ ዘለዓለም::? ሁሉ መዳንን ይወርሱ ዘንድ ስላላቸው ለማገዝ የሚላኩ የሚያገለግሉም መናፍስት አይደሉምን? (ዕብ 1:14፤)

Psalm 104:4 *"Who makes His angels spirits, His ministers a flame of fire."*
ዘይፈስዮሙ ለመላእክቲሁ መንፈሰ፤ ወለእለ ይትለአክዎ ነደ እሳት። መላእክቱን መንፈስ የሚያደርግ፥ አገልጋዮቹንም የእሳት ነበልባል። (መዝ 104:4)



The Human Spirit (The Soul)

Orthodox anthropology often views "Spirit" as the highest part of the human soul the part that is "in the image of God" and capable of communion with Him.

Allows a human to reason, have a conscience, and communicate with God.

Immortality: While the body is mortal, the spirit/soul is immortal and returns to God after death that survives physical death

Ecclesiastes 12:7 *"Then the dust will return to the earth as it was, and the spirit will return to God who gave it."*

Luke 23:46 Christ's final words, *"Father, into Your hands I commit My spirit,"* affirm the existence of a distinct spiritual entity within the human person



The human spirit is presented as an intuitive faculty capable of knowing and experiencing God.

- ✓ St. Paul writes, "The Spirit himself testifies with our spirit that we are God's children" (Romans 8:16), and in 1 Corinthians 2:10-12,
- ✓ St Paul explains that the Spirit of God enables humans to comprehend divine truths.

መኑ ብእሲ ዘየአምር ዘውስተ ልበ ሰብእ ዘእንበለ መንፈሱ ለሰብእ ዘላዕሌሁ? ወከማሁኬ ለእግዚአብሔርኒ አልቦ ዘየአምር ኀሊናሁ ዘእንበለ መንፈሱ ለእግዚአብሔር። በእርሱ ውስጥ ካለው ከሰው መንፈስ በቀር ለሰው ያለውን የሚያውቅ ሰው ማን ነው? እንዲሁም ደግሞ ከእግዚአብሔር መንፈስ በቀር ለእግዚአብሔር ያለውን ማንም አያውቅም። (1 ቆሮንቶስ 2:11)

For who among men knows the thoughts of a man except the man's spirit within him? In the same way no one knows the thoughts of God except the Spirit of God (1Cor 2:11).



The wind also called Spirit.

እስመ መንፈስ ኀበ ፈቀደ ይነፍሕ: ወቃሎ ትሰምዕ ወኢተአምር እምኀበ ይመጽእ ወኀበሂ የሐውር፤ ከማሁኬ ውእቱ ኵሉ ዘይትወለድ እመንፈስ ቅዱስ።" ነፋስ ወደሚወደው ይነፍሳል፥ ድምፁንም ትሰማለህ፥ ነገር ግን ከወዴት እንደ መጣ ወዴትም እንዲሄድ አታውቅም፤ ከመንፈስ የተወለደ ሁሉ እንዲሁ ነው።"(ዮሐንስ 3:8)

The wind blows wherever it pleases. You hear its sound, but you cannot tell where it comes from or where it is going. So it is with everyone born of the Spirit." (John 3:8)

Religion is also referred to as Spirit.

ወእለሂ ይሰግዱ ሎቱ በመንፈስ ወበጽድቅ ሀለዎሙ ይስግዱ ሎቱ።" የሚሰግዱለትም በመንፈስና በእውነት ሊሰግዱለት ያስፈልጋቸዋል።"ዮሐንስ 4:24





Teaching is also referred to as Spirit.

አንዊነ ለኵላ መንፈስ ኢትእመንዋ አላ አመክርዋ ለመንፈስ ለእመ እምኀበ እግዚአብሔር ይእቲ እስመ ብዙኃን ሐሳውያን ነቢያት መጽኡ ውስተ ዓለም፤ እለ ኢየአምርዎ ለኢየሱስ ክርስቶስ። ወዳጆች ሆይ፥ መንፈስን ሁሉ አትመኑ፥ ነገር ግን መናፍስት ከእግዚአብሔር ሆነው እንደ ሆነ መርምሩ፤ ብዙዎች ሐሰተኞች ነቢያት ወደ ዓለም ወጥተዋልና። (1ዮሐንስ 4:1፤)

Dear brothers, do not believe every spirit, but test the spirits to see whether they are from God because many false prophets have gone out into the world.(1 John 4:1,)

Will is also referred to as Spirit.

ወእምዝ ወሰዶ መንፈስ ገዳመ ለእግዚእ ኢየሱስ ከመ ይትመከር እምኀበ ዲያብሎስ። ከዚያ ወዲያ ኢየሱስ ከዲያብሎስ ይፈተን ዘንድ መንፈስ ወደ ምድረ በዳ ወሰደው:: (ማቴ 4:1፤)

Then Jesus was led by the Spirit into the desert to be tempted by the devil. (Mathew 4:1)



"Spirit" can also refer to the **Charismata** (gifts) or the "Spirit of Grace" bestowed upon believers through the Sacraments (Mysteries), especially *Meiron* (Confirmation).

Isaiah 11:2 Describes the "Sevenfold Spirit" (Spirit of wisdom, understanding, counsel, might, knowledge, fear of the Lord, and piety).

Galatians 5:22 The "Fruit of the Spirit," which are the moral manifestations of the Holy Spirit living within a person.

Satan is also referred to as Spirit.

ወምሴተ ከዊኖ አምጽኡ ኀቤሁ ብዙኃነ እለ አጋንንት ወአውፅኦሙ ለመናፍስት በቃሉ ወፈወሰ ኵሎ ድውያነ። በመሸም ጊዜ አጋንንት ያደረባቸውን ብዙዎችን ወደ እርሱ አመጡ፤ በነቢዩ በኢሳይያስ፦ "እርሱ ድካማችንን ተቀበለ ደዌያችንንም ተሸከመ፡" የተባለው ይፈጸም ዘንድ፥ መናፍስትን በቃሉ አወጣ፥ የታመሙትንም ሁሉ ፈወሰ። (ማቴ 8:16-17፤)

When evening came, many who were demon-possessed were brought to him, and he drove out the spirits with a word and healed all the sick. (Mathew 8:16).



Pneumatology

Pneuma, Greek, a noun which, depending on the context, can have the following meanings:

- ✓ The word "Pneumatology", is a combination of the following two Greek words:
- ✓ "spirit" (of God or for example of man), "wind", "breath" or "a spirit" in the sense of an angelic being.
- ✓ "In Classical Greek Πνευμα is with four discernible meanings: wind, breath, life, and metaphorical extensions of these reflecting the life-giving nature of the Holy Spirit
- ✓ "pneuma" and "logos" meaning "teaching (or doctrine) of the Spirit (of God)".
- ✓ When speaking of "Pneumatology", we are in no way thinking of teachings concerning spirits (i.e. the good and bad or fallen angels).
- ✓ That would be "Angelology" Pneumatology is the study of the person and work of the third person of the triune God (Trinity).



Ruah (רוּח)

Hebrew term equivalent for Greek Pneuma is ruach. Ruach (רוּח), which is translated into English as Spirit.

- ✓ "The word ruach appears 378 times in the Hebrew texts and 11 times in Aramaic passages". The word ruach literally means 'breath', 'wind' or 'breeze'.
- ✓ In the Old Testament the word ruach is uniformly employed for Spirit as referring to God's Spirit.
- ✓ Old Testament writers consider the breath in man as the divine element in Him.
- ✓ life principle, feelings and intelligence in man with the divine spark in him.
- ✓ ruach is the animating center in man.
- ✓ Anthropomorphism played a great role in identifying the breath with the Spirit.
- ✓ In Genesis 1:2, Ruach Elohim ("Spirit of God") is depicted hovering over the waters, signifying God's creative force.
- ✓ In Genesis 2:7, God breathes the ruach of life into humanity, imparting life and vitality.
- ✓ physical meaning, ruach vision where God's breath revives dry bones, representing Israel's restoration symbolizes spiritual renewal and divine intervention, as seen in Ezekiel's (Ezekiel 37:5-10).
- ✓ encapsulates the active and life-sustaining relationship between God and His creation.



Holy

- ✓ The word ‘Holy’ literally means ‘set apart or separated unto God’: hence blessed, righteous or sinless. The word therefore refers primarily to God as the source of holiness.

Because He is one of the persons of the triune God the Holy Spirit was involved in creation.

- ✓ Gen 1:1 In the beginning God created.



ጰራቅሊጦስ / መንፈስ ቅዱስ

“ፓራክሊቶስ” ወይም ከዕብራይስጡ “ፕራቅሊጥ” ከሚለው ግስ የተገኘው “ጰራቅሊጦስ” የሚለው ቃል ትርጉሙ “ አማላጅ ፣ አስታራቂ ፣ ፣ ጠበቃ ፣ ትርጁማን ፣ አምጃር ፣ እያጣፈጠ የሚናገር ፣ ስብቅል ካፉ ማር ጠብ የሚል። ... ፤ ናዛዚ ፣ መጽንዒ ፣ መስተፈስሒ ፤ መንፈስ ቅዱስ።” በማለት አለቃ ኪዳነ ወልድ ክፍሌ ፍሌ ተርጉመውታል። (ኪዳነ ወልድ ክፍሌ/አለቃ/፤ መጽሐፈ ሰዋሰው ወግስ ወመዝገበ ቃላት ሐዲስ።(1948 ዓ.ም)፤አርቲስ አርቲስቲክ ማተሚያ ቤት። ገጽ.907)

የመጽሐፍ ቅዱስ መተርጉማን ደግሞ ጰ[ፐ]ራቅሊጦስ የሚለውን ቃል በቀጥታ ፍቺው “ፓራ” ማለት “አጠገብ” ማለት ሲሆን ፤ “ካሌው” ማ ማለት ደግሞ “መጥራት” ብለው በመተርጎ፥ ሲተነትኑት “ሊራዳ ከአማኝ ጎን የሚቆም” በማለት ተርጉመውታል። ይህም ሊያጽናና፣ ሊያበረታታ ፣ ሊያረጋጋ ፣ሊራዳ ፣ ሊያማክር ፣ ፣ ሊሟገት ፣ ወገንና ወዳጅ ሆኖ ሊቀራረብ ከአማኝ ጎን ሃሳብን በውስጡ ይይዛል ብለዋል።

መንፈስ ቅዱስ ማን ነው?

አንዳንድ ሰዎች እንደ ረቂቅ ኃይል ይመለከቱታል፤ መጽሐፍ ቅዱስ ግን መንፈስ ቅዱስ እግዚአብሔር እንደሆነ ያውጃል።

ጰራቅሊጦስ / መንፈስ ቅዱስ

መጽሐፍ ቅዱስ ግን መንፈስ ቅዱስ እግዚአብሔር እንደሆነ ያውጃል። ከዚህ በተጨማሪም አእምሮ ያለው ማንነት፤ ስሜትና ፈቃድ ያለው **መለኮታዊ አካል** እንደሆነ ይነግረናል።

ቅዱስ ባስልዮስ «እኔ እግዚአብሔር በምልበት ጊዜ አብ ወልድ መንፈስ ቅዱስ ማለቴ ነው» ብሎ እንደተናገረው እግዚአብሔር የሚለው ስም የሥላሴ መጠሪያ ነው። የአብ የወልድ እስትንፋሳቸው የሆነ መንፈስ ቅዱስም ከአብ ከወልድ ጋር በዕሪና በፍጹም መተካከል ያለ ነውና እግዚአብሔር መሆኑን እንመሠክራለን።

ሱራፌል ቅዱስ ቅዱስ ቅዱስ ብለው ያመሰገኑበትን ምሥጢር ፤

ቅዱስ የሚለው ቃል አለመለወጡ፤ ሦስቱ አካላት በባሕርይ፤ በህልውና፤ በሥልጣን፤ በአገዛዝና በመሳሰለው አንድ መሆናቸው ሳይለወጥ ሦስት መሆኑ የእግዚአብሔርን የአካል ሦስትነት የሚገልጥ መሆኑን ያስረዳሉ።(ኢሳ.፮፥፭-፱)

ጰራቅሊጦስ / መንፈስ ቅዱስ

ወንጌላዊው ቅዱስ ዮሐንስም በእግዚአብሔር ዙፋን መካከል ያሉ የሰው፤ የአንበሳ፤ የላምና የንሥርን ፊት ይመስላሉ። እነርሱም ኪሩቤል ቃሉ ሳይለወጥ **«ቅዱስ ቅዱስ ቅዱስ፤ የነበረና ያለ፤ የሚመጣውም፤ ሁሉንም የሚገዛ ጌታ አምላክ»** እያሉ ቀንና ሌሊት ያለ ዕረፍት እንደሚያመሰግኑ መናገሩ ነው። (ራእ.፬፥፰)

ቅዱስ ጴጥሮስ ሐናንያ ለምን እንደዋሸ ሲጠይቀው **“ሐናንያ ሆይ መንፈስ ቅዱስን ታታልልና ከመሬቱ ሽያጭ ታስቀር ዘንድ ሰይጣን ስለምን በልብህ ሞላ? ሳትሸጠው የአንተ አልነበረምን? ከሸጥከውስ በኋላ በሥልጣንህ አልነበረምን? ይህንን ነገር በልብህ ስለምን አሰብህ? እግዚአብሔርን እንጂ ሰውን አልዋሸህም አለው”** ይለናል። እንግዲህ ከዚህ ታይለ ቃል ሐናንያ እግዚአብሔርን እንጂ ሰውን እንዳልዋሸ፤ ይህ ደግሞ መንፈስ ቅዱስ እግዚአብሔር እንደሆነ በግልጽ እንረዳለን(የሐዋ.ሥራ ፭፥፫-፬)።

«እግዚአብሔር መንፈስ ነው» ብሎናል። (ዮሐ. ፬፥፳፬) እግዚአብሔር መንፈስ መባሉም አካል የሌለው ማለት ሳይሆን አካሉ የማይመረመር የማይዳሰስ የማይጨበጥ የማይታይ መሆኑን ለመገለጽ ሲሆን መንፈስ ቅዱስም መንፈስ መባሉም አካላዊና አካሉም ረቂቅ መሆኑን ለመግለጥ ነው።
ስለዚህም ሁሉን የሚችል የአምላክ እስትንፋስ የተባለ መንፈስ ቅዱስ የአብ የወልድ አካላዊ እስትንፋሳቹው ነው። አካላዊ በመሆኑም ከአብና ከወልድ ጋር በክብር ዙፋኑ ላይ ተቀምጦ ለነቢዩ ኢሳይያስ ተገልጧል።(ኢሳ.፮፥፩-፬፤የሐዋ. ፳፰፥፳)

“የእግዚአብሔር መንፈስ ፈጠረኝ፤ ሁሉን የሚችል የአምላክ እስትንፋስ ሕይወትን ሰጠኝ” እንደዚሁም “በመንፈሱ ሰማያት ውበትን አገኙ”